

ASSIGNMENT #3

Descriptive Writing & Storytelling

Beyond the Character: Journey through Pivotal Moments

Overview

Stories live in moments, not in summaries, not in timelines, but in the specific, charged instants where a character's world shifts. This assignment invites you to create one such moment.

You will design an original character, place them inside a pivotal moment in their journey, and bring that moment to life as a manga or comic chapter. The process moves through three modes of thinking, character design, descriptive writing, and visual storytelling, and asks you to work across all three with intention and craft.

This is an individual assignment. Every character, every description, every creative decision must be your own.

What This Assignment Is About

At its core this is a descriptive writing assignment. The visual format is the medium, not the goal. Your written descriptions, of your character, their world, their moment, are the foundation everything else is built on. The stronger and more specific your writing, the richer your final comic will be.

You will also work with AI image generation tools to produce the visual pages of your chapter. This is not a shortcut; it is an additional creative challenge. Translating precise written descriptions into effective AI prompts requires the same skills as descriptive writing: specificity, intentionality, and a critical eye for detail.

The Assignment at a Glance

The worksheet guides you through five parts:

Part A — Character Design: Build your character from the ground up, their traits, backstory, moral code, contradictions, and the world they inhabit.

Part B — The Moment: Select and develop a specific pivotal moment in your character's journey. Describe the scene, the stakes, the emotions, the sensory details, and what shifts before and after.

Part C — Page Planning: Plan your comic chapter, a cover page and three story pages, each with 4 to 6 panels. For every panel, describe what is shown, the shot type, mood, lighting, and any dialogue or captions.

Part D — AI Image Generation: Use an AI image generation tool of your choice to produce your panels. Document your prompts, your process, the challenges you faced, and how you adapted.

Part E — Reflection: Step back and interpret the experience, what the visual format revealed about your character, how your writing shaped your visual output, what you now understand about descriptive writing, and how AI functioned as a creative tool in your process.

Deliverables

Submit the following as part of your assignment:

1. **Completed worksheet:** all parts filled in fully, with word counts respected
2. **Final comic:** Cover page + 3 story pages, each containing your AI-generated panel images assembled in order
3. **AI chat link:** a shareable link to your AI tool conversation, or a written description of your prompting process if your tool does not support shareable links

All components must be submitted together as a single submission.

A Note on Academic Integrity & AI Use

Using AI image generation tools is a required and transparent part of this assignment. However, the creative thinking, written descriptions, character design, and storytelling decisions must all be your own. AI is a tool to realize your vision, not to generate it.

You are fully responsible for the prompts you write and the images you submit. Review all generated images carefully before submitting.

GUIDELINES FOR DESIGNING AND DEVELOPING YOUR WORK

- **Respectful Representation:** Design and portray characters in a respectful and dignified manner. Avoid solely focusing on physical appearance and superficial characteristics.
- **Avoiding Stereotypes:** Be mindful of avoiding stereotypes or clichés when creating your characters. Think critically about how you portray gender, race, and other identity factors where applicable.
- **Sensitivity to Cultural Norms:** Consider the sensitivities of the community when designing your character and descriptions. Be aware of cultural context and avoid descriptions that may be perceived as inappropriate or offensive.
- **Consider the Audience:** Create characters and descriptions that align with the values and expectations of your intended audience.
- **Depth & Complexity:** Develop characters with depth and complexity, considering more than just the physical attributes. Think about your character's personality traits, motivations, emotions and relationships describing them.
- **Focus on Inner Qualities:** Concentrate on describing the inner qualities and experiences of your character such as their thoughts, feelings, and personal growth.
- **Political & Controversial Figures:** Do not base your character on, or incorporate real political figures, public figures, or controversial personalities into your story. Your character must be entirely fictional. Kindly discuss with your instructor in the case your work incorporates any such aspects for approval.
- **Sensitive Historical Events:** If your story world draws on historical contexts, handle them with respect and critical awareness.
- **Strictly Prohibited Content:** The glorification, promotion, or normalization of drugs, alcohol, smoking, substance abuse, self-harm, or any illegal activity is strictly prohibited in this assignment. This applies to both your written work and your AI-generated images. **Any**

submission found to contain such content will receive an automatic 50% deduction across both the written and visual components of the assignment, regardless of the quality of other elements.

- **AI Prompt Responsibility:** Students are fully responsible for the prompts they write and the images they submit. If your AI-generated images contain prohibited content, the penalty applies regardless of whether the output was intentional. Review all generated images carefully before submitting.